

Λυρικά Ἀδέσποτα

Anonymous Lyric Fragments on Apollo and Bacchus

eul_aid: cyo

Period: *Κλασική* [Classical](#)
Dialect: *Μικταὶ διάλεκτοι* [Mixed Dialects](#) (frg)
Domain: *Ποίησις* [Poetry](#)
Format: *Ἑμμετρος* [Verse](#)

Lyrica Adespota is not an author but a collective term for anonymous fragments of Greek lyric poetry. The designation means “lyrics without an owner.” These fragments, transmitted through quotations in later authors, papyri, and inscriptions, date largely from the Archaic and Classical periods, from the 7th to the 5th centuries BCE. The original poets were active across the Greek world, and their works were performed in typical social, religious, and competitive contexts.

No biography exists for this corpus; scholarship focuses on textual reconstruction, metrical analysis, and situating the fragments within the history of Greek lyric. The corpus comprises numerous short, often fragmentary poems compiled in modern editions such as Denys Page’s **Poetae Melici Graeci** and Malcolm Davies’s **Poetarum Melicorum Graecorum Fragmenta**.

Notable examples include the “Linos-song” and the complete inscribed “Song of Seikilos.” These anonymous fragments are significant for revealing the breadth of Greek lyric beyond major figures like Sappho or Pindar. They offer glimpses into popular song, cult practice, and poetic tradition, preserving rare words, mythological references, and metrical forms that supplement the known canon.

Works (1)

- [Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Ἀπόλλωνος καὶ Βάκχου](#) · [Fragments on Apollo and Bacchus](#) · 231 passages